

URED-2302 (Sciences of Qu'ran & Hadith)

Previous Semester Final Exam Question Solutions (Combined)

Disclaimer: While this document uses AI for content creation, it strictly follows the style and content of the course theory. Some explanations may be simplified or reworded to support better understanding. It is best used alongside proper academic materials and teacher guidance.

1. Define Makki and Madani Surahs. Summarize their extraordinary characteristics. Why was the holy Qur'an divided into Makki and Madani Surahs?

Makki and Madani Surahs are classifications of the chapters of the Holy Qur'an based on the period and place of their revelation. **Makki Surahs** are those revealed before the Hijrah (migration) of Prophet Muhammad (SAAS) to Madinah, regardless of the place, while **Madani Surahs** were revealed after the Hijrah, whether in Madinah or during travels. This division helps in understanding the context, background, and purpose of various revelations. Makki Surahs mainly focus on strengthening faith (Iman), Tawheed (oneness of Allah), the Day of Judgment, Paradise and Hell, and stories of previous prophets to establish moral lessons. These surahs are generally short, rhythmic, powerful, and emotional, aiming to awaken hearts and appeal to intellect. On the other hand, Madani Surahs are longer and deal with **Islamic laws, social justice, economic systems, rules of war and peace, marriage, inheritance, and relations with non-Muslims**. They also address the **hypocrites (Munafiqeen)** and **People of the Book (Jews and Christians)**. The Qur'an was divided into Makki and Madani Surahs to distinguish between the two phases of Islam: the period of **persecution and struggle in Makkah**, and the period of **establishment and legislation in Madinah**. This classification aids scholars in Tafsir (interpretation) and helps Muslims to understand the growth and application of Islamic principles in different stages of the Prophet's mission.

2. Explain how the holy Qur'an was preserved during the time of Prophet Muhammad (SAAS), Abu Bakr (RA), and Uthman (RA). Why wasn't it compiled during the Prophet's lifetime? Identify the differences in the preservation efforts of Abu Bakr and Uthman.

The preservation of the Holy Qur'an was a priority from the beginning of Islam. During the **lifetime of Prophet Muhammad (SAAS)**, the Qur'an was preserved through **three primary methods**: memorization, written record, and constant recitation. The Prophet had a number of **Huffaz (memorizers)** among his companions and **appointed scribes** like Zayd ibn Thabit to write

down the revelations on bones, parchments, leather, and other available materials. However, the Qur'an was **not compiled into a single book** during his life because **revelation was ongoing**, and the Prophet himself supervised the arrangement of verses and chapters as instructed by Angel Jibreel. After the Prophet's death, during the **Khilafah of Abu Bakr (RA)**, a large number of Huffaz were martyred in the Battle of Yamama, prompting Caliph Umar (RA) to suggest the compilation of the Qur'an. Abu Bakr (RA) assigned Zayd ibn Thabit to collect and compile the Qur'an in a single manuscript (Mushaf), based on both memorization and written materials verified by multiple witnesses. This copy was kept with Hafsa (RA). Later, during the caliphate of **Uthman ibn Affan (RA)**, as Islam spread to non-Arab regions, **differences in recitation** and dialect led to disputes. Uthman (RA) ordered the preparation of a standardized Mushaf based on the Qurayshi dialect and sent **copies to various regions**, burning the others to preserve unity in recitation. Therefore, Abu Bakr's effort was the **first compilation for preservation**, while Uthman's effort was the **standardization and mass distribution** to protect the Qur'an from linguistic corruption.

3. Illustrate the I'jaz (miraculous nature) of the holy Qur'an by summarizing different types of its miracles, including scientific indications. Prove it as the greatest miracle of Prophet Muhammad (SAAS) with evidence.

The **I'jaz al-Qur'an** refers to the miraculous nature of the Qur'an that makes it **inimitable** and beyond human capacity to produce something like it. The Qur'an challenged Arabs, known for their eloquence, to produce a **chapter like it**, yet no one succeeded, proving its **linguistic miracle**. The Qur'an is a literary masterpiece with **unmatched eloquence, rhythm, and depth**, free from contradictions despite being revealed over 23 years. Its **scientific miracles** include facts that were unknown at the time but confirmed later by modern science, such as the **development of the human embryo (Surah Al-Mu'minun: 12-14)**, the **expansion of the universe (Surah Adh-Dhariyat: 47)**, the **barrier between salt and fresh water (Surah Ar-Rahman: 19-20)**, and more. The Qur'an also foretold future events such as the **victory of the Romans over Persians (Surah Ar-Rum: 2-4)**, which was fulfilled. Another miracle is its **preservation**, as it remains unchanged for over 1400 years, unlike any previous scripture. The Qur'an also **transforms hearts**, reforms societies, and guides millions across generations. Prophet Muhammad (SAAS) said, *"All Prophets were given miracles, but I was given the revelation (Qur'an), so I hope to have the most followers on the Day of Judgment."* Thus, the Qur'an is the **everlasting miracle**, continuing to guide humanity, unlike the time-bound miracles of previous prophets.

4. Define *Naskh* (Abrogation) literally and terminologically. Explain its types in the Qur'an and Hadith with examples.

Naskh literally means **to erase, copy, or replace**. Terminologically, it refers to the **removal or replacement of a previous Islamic ruling** by a subsequent one, as commanded by Allah. It was necessary because Islam was revealed gradually to suit the developing moral, social, and legal circumstances of the early Muslim community. Abrogation shows **Allah's wisdom in legislation**, allowing laws to adapt as society matures. The Qur'an mentions: *"Whatever verse We abrogate or cause to be forgotten, We bring one better or similar to it"* (Surah Al-Baqarah: 106). There are **three main types of Naskh**:

1. **Naskh al-Hukm wa al-Tilawah (abrogation of ruling and recitation)**: Both the verse and its legal ruling are abrogated. For example, the verse about stoning an adulterer is not found in the Mushaf but was practiced earlier.
 2. **Naskh al-Tilawah duna al-Hukm (abrogation of recitation, ruling remains)**: The verse is removed from the Qur'an but its ruling remains, such as the verse about breastfeeding an adult.
 3. **Naskh al-Hukm duna al-Tilawah (abrogation of ruling, recitation remains)**: The verse is still in the Qur'an, but the ruling is no longer applicable. An example is Surah Al-Baqarah: 180 about bequests, which was replaced by detailed inheritance laws.
- Naskh also applies in Hadith where **a later Hadith replaces or updates an earlier ruling**, such as initially facing **Jerusalem in prayer**, later changed to facing **Ka'bah**. Naskh preserves **flexibility in law** while upholding divine wisdom and ensuring gradual ease in implementing Islamic principles.

5. Explain the position and importance of Hadith in Islamic Shari'ah. How does Hadith differ from the Qur'an in terms of authority, purpose, and usage in Islamic law?

Hadith holds a **central position in Islamic Shari'ah** as it is the second most important source of Islamic law after the Qur'an. While the Qur'an provides the **foundation**, the Hadith provides the **detailed explanation** (Tafsir), **practical implementation**, and **supplementary rulings** necessary to fully understand and apply the Qur'an. Allah commanded obedience to the Prophet (SAAS) in many verses, such as *"Obey Allah and obey the Messenger..."* (Surah An-Nisa: 59). The Prophet's actions, approvals, and sayings are recorded in Hadith, making them essential for legal, moral, and social guidance. Hadith explains how to perform **Salat, fasting, Hajj, and Zakat**, all of which are mentioned generally in the Qur'an. In terms of **authority**, the Qur'an is **divine revelation in word and meaning**, while Hadith is **revelation in meaning only**, as the Prophet spoke with divine guidance. The Qur'an is **mutawatir and completely preserved**, while Hadith has varying levels of authenticity, such as **Sahih, Hasan, Da'if, and Mawdu'**. In usage, Qur'an gives **general principles**, while Hadith **details specific laws**, interprets verses, and offers rulings not explicitly mentioned in the Qur'an. Without Hadith, it would be impossible to practice Islam as a

complete way of life. Therefore, Hadith is indispensable in **deriving Fiqh**, shaping Islamic jurisprudence, and preserving the Prophet's legacy.

6a. Define Hadith both literally and terminologically. Explain its types based on:

- The number of reporters in the *Sanad* at each stage
- Reference to a particular authority
(Include suitable examples.)

Definition of Hadith (Literally and Terminologically):

The word *Hadith* literally means something new, a report, or a story. In Islamic terminology, it refers to everything that has been narrated from the Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him), including his statements, actions, silent approvals, habits, manners, physical features, and his biography. These reports are considered essential for understanding Islam and practicing it as the Prophet exemplified its teachings in real life.

An example of his statement is the famous Hadith: *"Actions are judged by intentions, and every person will get what he intended..."* This Hadith is narrated by Umar ibn al-Khattab and recorded in Sahih al-Bukhari and Sahih Muslim. Another example of his action is the report by Aisha (RA) that the Prophet used to sleep on his right side after performing the Sunnah of Fajr (Sahih Bukhari). His silent approval is when he saw the companions offering two Rak'ahs before Maghrib and did not object to it (Sahih Muslim). His behavior is also reported, such as when the Prophet was described as more modest than a veiled girl, and his disapproval would show on his face (Sahih Bukhari and Muslim).

Types of Hadith Based on the Number of Reporters in Each Stage of the Chain (Sanad):

1. **Mutawatir Hadith:** These are narrations reported by a large number of narrators in every generation of the chain, making it impossible for all to agree on a lie. It provides certain knowledge.
Example: "Whoever intentionally lies about me, let him reserve his seat in Hell." (Sahih al-Bukhari and Muslim)
2. **Ahad Hadith:** These are reports not reaching the level of mutawatir. They are divided into:
 - **Mashhur** (well-known): Initially narrated by a few but became widely known later.
Example: "Actions are judged by intentions..." (Sahih al-Bukhari)
 - **Aziz** (rare): Reported by at least two narrators at some point.
Example: "None of you truly believes until I become more beloved to him than his father, children, and all people." (Sahih al-Bukhari)

- **Gharib** (strange): Reported by only one narrator at any stage.
Example: "Travel is a part of torment." (Sahih Bukhari)

Types of Hadith Based on Reference to Authority:

1. **Marfoo'**: A narration attributed directly to the Prophet.
Example: "Actions are judged by intentions..." narrated by Umar (Sahih al-Bukhari)
2. **Mawqoof**: A narration from a Companion but not attributed to the Prophet.
Example: Ali (RA) said, "Preach to people according to their level of understanding."
3. **Maqtoo'**: A statement from a Successor (Tabi'ee), not a Companion or Prophet.
Example: Hasan al-Basri said, "You can pray behind an evil Imam, his sin is on him."

Or,

6b. Explain the following with examples:

- Sanad & Matan
- Al-Hadith As-Sahih
- Al-Hadith Al-Qudsi
- Al-Hadith Al-Mawdu'
- Six major books of Hadith (Al-Kutub As-Sittah)

i. Sanad and Matan:

- **Sanad** is the chain of narrators who transmitted a Hadith. It validates the authenticity by tracing it back to the source.
- **Matan** is the content or actual text of the Hadith.

Example: In the Hadith "Actions are judged by intentions..." the names of all narrators before the Prophet's words form the Sanad, and the quoted statement is the Matan. (Sahih Bukhari, Book 1, Hadith 1)

ii. Saheeh Hadith (Authentic Hadith):

A Hadith with a continuous and reliable chain of narrators, all known for honesty and accuracy, and free from contradictions or hidden flaws.

Example: "Actions are judged by intentions..." (Sahih Bukhari, Hadith 1)

iii. Hadith Qudsi:

These are special Hadiths where the Prophet conveys a message from Allah using his own words, but it's not part of the Qur'an.

Example: "Allah said: I am as My servant thinks I am..." (Sahih al-Bukhari, Hadith 7405)

iv. Maudoo' Hadith (Fabricated):

A fabricated narration falsely attributed to the Prophet, often to promote certain ideas or practices. It's identified by flaws in content or by known liars in the Sanad.

Example: "Whoever talks in the mosque, his deeds are wasted like grass eaten by a cow." – This is a fabricated Hadith as no authentic source supports it.

v. The Six Major Books of Hadith (Al-Kutub As-Sittah):

These are the six most important collections of Hadith in Sunni Islam:

1. **Sahih al-Bukhari** – Compiled by Imam Bukhari, the most authentic Hadith collection.
2. **Sahih Muslim** – Compiled by Imam Muslim, second in authenticity.
3. **Sunan Abu Dawood** – Known for Hadiths related to legal rulings.
4. **Jami' at-Tirmidhi** – Includes classification and commentary on Hadiths.
5. **Sunan an-Nasa'i** – Focuses on Fiqh-related Hadiths.
6. **Sunan Ibn Majah** – Includes unique Hadiths not found in other collections.

These books were compiled using strict standards and cover all aspects of Islamic life – belief, worship, character, law, and history.